

ROBEL TAMIRU SEBSIBE

Creative Director · Art Director · Brand & Experiential

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PROFILE

Creative Director with 5+ years taking work from concept to delivery across experiential, social, digital, and brand, built almost entirely inside African cultural spaces: nightlife series, live events, music, and a 20,000-piece African art catalog. Has produced 500+ concepts and 100+ campaigns on small budgets, frequently as the only designer on the job. Directs project-based creative teams from brief through delivery, and owns the room in client, stakeholder, and investor pitches.

SKILLS

Direction: Creative Direction · Art Direction · Concepting · Pitch & Client Presentation · Team Leadership · Brand Identity Systems

Channels: Experiential & Live Events · Stage & Environmental Design · Social & Digital · Short-Form Video · Packaging · Print · Editorial

Tools: Adobe Illustrator · Photoshop · InDesign · Premiere Pro · After Effects · Figma · DaVinci Resolve · CapCut · Midjourney

Production: Product & Event Photography · Shoot Direction · Reels/TikTok · Motion Graphics · Color Grading · Retouching

EXPERIENCE

Social Media Editor · OkayAfrica (Areya Media) · Remote

Oct 2025 – Present

- Produce editorial and social creative for OkayAfrica, covering African music, culture, and the diaspora across the brand's social channels on a daily publishing schedule.
- Work with the editorial team to turn newsroom priorities into social-first creative, keeping the visual voice consistent across formats.

Art Director & Photographer · Africa Direct · Aurora, CO

Jun 2025 – Oct 2025

- Sole creative for a catalog of 20,000+ African art and cultural products, directing and executing every channel: social, digital, packaging, print, and in-person activations.
- Concepted and produced brand-aligned visual systems and educational infographics that turned cultural heritage into customer-facing stories, supporting direct sales and community partnership goals.

Creative Director & Art Director · Afromile PLC · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Nov 2022 – Nov 2024

- Led creative direction for a multi-brand group spanning live events, e-commerce, and media, guiding the creative team from brief through delivery across 100+ campaigns and driving a 40% increase in event ticket sales.
- Built and directed creative teams that changed size from project to project, setting the pace and the standard for high output across several brands at once.
- Owned client and stakeholder presentations, building brand identity systems, visual guidelines, and investor pitch decks for C-level audiences; partnered with marketing, growth, and editorial to align creative with business goals.
- Directed shoots and produced short-form video, motion graphics, reels, and event content across TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube.

Key brands and accounts

- **British Council Ethiopia:** Art Creates campaign delivered to exact brand spec with zero revisions.
- **Atmosphere Events:** 500+ original campaign visuals for a high-frequency nightlife series.
- **Linkup Addis Media & Events:** Directed 10+ full branded event experiences, including Zoya (Addis Ababa's leading electronic music event), Takeno, and Tribes. Work covered stage design, signage, digital, print, and experiential touchpoints, plus monthly magazine and weekly newsletter production.

FREELANCE & CONTRACT

Various Clients · Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Feb 2021 – Dec 2024

- **Venture Addis** (Dec 2023 – Dec 2024): Stage visuals, event badges, and real-time social creative for live performance events.
- **IConnect Plus** (May 2023 – Mar 2024): Brand identity systems, logos, stationery, and marketing assets for corporate clients.
- **Bete Semay** (Oct 2023 – Feb 2024): Art directed thumbnails and stills for a YouTube channel with 60,000+ subscribers, improving branding and retention.
- **202 Africa** (Feb 2021 – Nov 2022): Branded product campaigns merging artisan photography with digital strategy across print and social.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc, Architecture · Addis Ababa Science and Technology University

Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

Adobe Certified Professional, Graphic Design · Adobe

2024

AI and Career Empowerment · University of Maryland, Robert H. Smith School of Business

Jun 2025